

Mr Karan Adani, MD, APSEZ, and Director, Adani Cement, at the platinum jubilee celebrations of AIMA in New Delhi on February 21.



Mr Jeet Adani, Director, AAHL, at the commencement of commercial operations of the new terminal of Guwahati airport on February 22.



Mr Gautam Adani with frontline workers at the Godda power plant in Jharkhand on February 22.

Delhi on February 20 focused on institutional strength and long-term resilience.

Speaking at the platinum jubilee celebrations of the All India Management Association, Mr Karan Adani, Managing Director (MD) of Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone (APSEZ) and Director of Adani Cement, outlined how the conglomerate is aligning investments around three enduring pillars: energy, logistics and core materials critical to India's development.

Energy remains central, spanning generation, city gas distribution and transmission networks, while extending into emerging digital assets such as data centres. The Group's $100 billion commitment towards renewable energy-powered infrastructure by 2035 forms the backbone of its long-term ambitions in artificial intelligence and compute capacity.

That commitment was announced during the AI Impact Summit 2026 held in New Delhi from February 16 to 21. Addressing the gathering, Mr Jeet Adani, the youngest son of Mr Gautam Adani and Director of Adani Airport Holdings Limited (AAHL), described energy, compute and services sovereignty as the three foundations of India's AI century. Renewable energy-backed data centres and digital infrastructure, he argued, are no longer optional adjacencies to industrial growth but essential to national competitiveness. The infrastructure being built today must anticipate India's demand for high-performance computing, AI-training capacity and sovereign digital ecosystems, positioning energy and data as twin engines of the next growth cycle.

On defence participation, indigenisation was framed as a strategic imperative. Maintenance, repair and overhaul (MRO) capabilities, alongside partnerships with global aerospace players, are envisioned as building blocks of a broader aviation and defence ecosystem that integrates domestic manufacturing into global supply chains.

Restoring speed and scalability while reducing structural complexity is now a priority, Mr Karan Adani acknowledged. Institutionalisation, broader partnerships and sharper communication frameworks are part of that reset.

The Group is also recalibrating its workforce profile. With an average employee age of 38, it aims to lower that number to accelerate AI-adoption and digital transformation. Female workforce participation has risen from 2 per cent to 15 per cent while around 80 per cent of leadership has been developed internally, with mobility encouraged across ports, airports, cement and mining operations.

In a business climate shaped by regulatory scrutiny and heightened global attention, the emphasis is clear. Operating fundamentals, recurring infrastructure revenues and transparent engagement form the bedrock of resilience.

A Gateway for the North-East

If power plants represent industrial muscle, airports express economic aspiration and regional pride.

At the commercial launch of the new terminal at Lokapriya Gopinath Bardoloi International Airport (LGBIA) in Guwahati on February 22, Mr Jeet Adani described the structure as "Assam in form, colour and soul." Designed to handle over 13.1 million passengers annually, the terminal blends performance with cultural symbolism.

Incorporating 140 metric tonnes (MT) of locally sourced *bholuka* bamboo shaped by Assamese artisans, the terminal reflects regional identity through orchid-themed columns, motifs echoing the traditional *jhapi* (headgear) and landscapes inspired by Kaziranga National Park and the one-horn rhinoceros. A Sky Forest arrival zone featuring over 100,000 plants from 100 native species offers a distinctive passenger experience, while remote check-in, self-bag drop and automated tray retrieval systems reflect a digital-first approach.

For decades, the North-East has sought deeper integration into India's economic mainstream. Connectivity has often defined its opportunity. The new terminal at LGBIA positions Assam as a gateway, linking culture with commerce and sustainability with scale and reinforcing the region's place on India's economic map.

The Larger Arc

Taken together, these strands, power generation in eastern India, governance recalibration in the capital and aviation infrastructure in the North-East, outline a larger arc of nation-building.

In Jharkhand and Bihar, capital is being deployed where industrialisation has lagged and where few large corporate houses previously committed at this scale. At the Group headquarters in Ahmedabad, corporate architecture is being strengthened to match ambition with accountability. In Guwahati, infrastructure doubles as identity, signalling that development need not erase local character.

The underlying thesis is clear—India's next leap will not be powered by isolated assets, but by interconnected systems, energy feeding logistics, support chain-enabling industry, airports catalysing regional economies and digital infrastructure binding it all together.

From temple steps in Deoghar to turbines in Godda and bamboo-lined terminals in Guwahati, the narrative converges. Faith, execution and reform are not separate strands, they form a single proposition—infrastructure, executed with intent and anchored in institutional strength, can become the architecture of national ambition.